

Chris Kizziar

IT Operations Leader | Cloud Modernization, M&A & Digital Transformation | High-Growth Scaling

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SUMMARY

Seasoned IT Operations leader experienced in scaling infrastructure and teams through rapid growth, acquisition, and divestiture. Supported expansion from 109 to 1,500+ employees and growth of the IT organization from 5 to 51 professionals, then led the IT separation of the business into three buyers. Delivered 8 acquisition integrations, 4 ERP migrations, 80% cloud migration, two datacenter retirements, and ransomware recovery with zero data loss – managing a \$4.9M annual operating budget alongside \$6.45M in capital project delivery.

SKILLS

- IT Strategy & Operations, Cloud Migration & Modernization (Azure + AWS), M&A Integration & Post-Merger Consolidation, Cybersecurity & Incident Response, Team Leadership & Talent Development, Digital Transformation & Process Automation, Budget Management & Cost Optimization, ERP Implementation & Migration, Infrastructure Scaling & Datacenter Consolidation, Disaster Recovery & Business Continuity, Stakeholder & Executive Alignment, DevOps & IT Infrastructure Management

WORK EXPERIENCE

Independent IT Consultant, Crescent Energy | Aug 2026 – Present

Oklahoma City, OK (Remote)

- Retained by the Head of Enterprise Services to stabilize an active enterprise outage and provide interim leadership of the network function following the company's divestiture and reorganization
- Directing network and OT communications operations while supporting recruitment of a permanent network manager

IT Operations Manager, Crescent Energy | Dec 2019 – Jul 2026

Oklahoma City, OK

- Played a key role in scaling IT operations during rapid company growth, supporting expansion from 109 to 1,500+ employees while the IT organization grew from 5 to 51 professionals across a 60-location footprint
- Built and led infrastructure, engineering, and operations teams of up to 11 across two management layers; hired 12 people over six years, promoted from within, and placed three team members with the acquirer through the divestiture
- Directed integration of 8 major acquisitions (adding 1,100 employees and 51 new sites), delivered 4 ERP migrations, retired 2 datacenters, and migrated ~80% of systems to the cloud (Azure and AWS)
- Led ransomware recovery with zero data loss in four weeks; strengthened cybersecurity, optimized cloud and datacenters, saving \$230,000 annually within a \$4.9M IT operating budget.
- Directed the IT workstream of the 2025–26 divestiture, separating a 550-user multi-state operating company into three buyers simultaneously – 18 field offices, 11 communications towers, ~40TB of data and 480+ mobile assets – under a Transition Services Agreement I scoped and renegotiated
- Owned \$6.45M of IT capital across four corporate office buildouts housing 310+ people, including two delivered concurrently and a headquarters fit-out coordinated with the firm's private equity sponsor

Senior SecOps Architect / Information Security Analyst, Symphony Talent | May 2018 – Dec 2019

Edmond, OK

- Architected and deployed enterprise cloud security solutions across 15+ AWS accounts and multiple global regions, reducing attack surface and strengthening overall SecOps posture
- Automated traffic monitoring, security analytics, and blocking processes across ~20 publicly accessible solution stacks, improving threat detection and minimizing exposure across business units
- Managed identity and access management (IAM) controls for AWS accounts, internal networks, and business applications, enforcing least-privilege policies and enhancing access governance
- Conducted penetration testing and vulnerability assessments across multiple platforms; prioritized and remediated findings to reduce critical and high-risk vulnerabilities

Senior DevOps / Windows Engineer, Symphony Talent | Nov 2014 – May 2018

Edmond, OK

- Provided technical leadership for Windows engineering and infrastructure modernization, developing roadmaps for datacenter virtualization, consolidation, and cloud transformation in AWS and Azure
- Designed and automated secure cloud architectures, integrating Active Directory, Group Policy, DNS, and account provisioning to support scalable DevOps and SecOps environments
- Managed, optimized, and secured 500+ Microsoft SQL Server databases (including multi-terabyte instances), strengthening backup/recovery processes and database security practices
- Partnered with the Bangalore development organization on deployment pipelines and shared cloud standards; delivered a two-week on-site training program for DevOps engineers and developers, sustained through recurring remote sessions
- Built an AWS-based machine learning platform (Lambda, S3, RDS) that allocated recruitment advertising spend from historical performance data, automating channel budget recommendations for enterprise talent acquisition clients

Windows Server Engineer / SQL Engineer, Computer Services, Inc. | Feb 2013 – Nov 2014

Oklahoma City, OK

- Administered enterprise Windows Server and SQL Server environments, troubleshooting complex issues to increase system uptime and stabilize critical business services
- Executed system upgrades, security patches, and performance monitoring while optimizing alerts, strengthening cybersecurity and reducing incident response times by 30%
- Developed and maintained standard operating procedures for virtualization, systems administration, and SQL database management, improving process consistency by 25% and accelerating IT service delivery

Sr Database Administrator / Systems Engineer, Quality Support Services | Apr 2011 – Feb 2013

Tinker AFB, OK

- Engineered high-availability clustered databases in a fully virtualized environment and optimized data models/indexes to enhance performance for mission-critical applications
- Designed and managed backup, recovery, and disaster recovery strategies, including secure off-site tape storage, reducing data loss risk and improving business continuity

Database Administrator, Lockheed Martin/BAE Systems | Dec 2008 – Apr 2011

Ft. Stewart, GA

- Designed and implemented data automation tools that improved asset visibility and equipment accountability across the 3rd Infantry Division
- Integrated multiple military databases and disparate data formats to achieve 100% data accuracy and ensure Army force readiness compliance
- Served as Information Management Officer (IMO) and Information Assurance Security Officer (IASO); remediated security vulnerabilities and developed a database system that delivered **over \$418 million** in internal cost savings

GIS Analyst / IT Services Specialist, Glynn County Board of Commissioners | Nov 2006 – Dec 2008

Brunswick, GA

- Managed Oracle-based GIS data systems and the full IT hardware lifecycle; authored documentation and delivered training, and administered electronic voting systems testing and security audits for regulatory compliance

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Information Technology Management, Western Governors University | Jun 2026

Bachelor's Degree in Information Technology Security, Western Governors University | Jun 2018